Four Pac 10 teams to play in NCAA tournament

SPORTS

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A PULITZER PRIZE-WINNING NEWSPAPER

OAKLAND, CALIFORNIA | METRO EDITION | MONDAY, MARCH 16, 1992

This Kidd's a real Eastbay celebrity

By Anna Cearley
Tribune Staff Writer

ALAMEDA — Jason Kidd is not on the front of a Wheaties cereal box yet, but the high school basketball sensation already is creating a celebrity mania here.

He's the "Wiz Kidd," and if you don't believe it, just look around the St. Joseph of Notre Dame campus. Students and fans alike sport Wiz Kidd T-shirts, buttons, caps and posters.

Kidd's coach, Frank LaPorte, ordered 350 Kidd posters, 100 T-shirts, 35 caps and 50 buttons featuring the senior point guard when the year began. The items were practically sold out last week, and that was before Kidd led the Roman Catholic high school to the state championship this weekend with a 34-point performance over stubborn rival Jesuit High School.

"It's like having Bo Jackson," said Chris Ray, a 10th grader at the school.

"It's significant because we have him here," said Ray, who has a full color poster of Kidd executing an awesome slam dunk.

Tenth-grade student Frank Garcia, said the Kidd phenomenon is about just one thing — school spirit.

"He has made the community more (aware of us)," said Garcia, who sports a Kidd button. "Even though we are a small school, we are able to have a star team and that's a plus."

The popularity of the paraphernalia has caught Kidd off guard, something that almost never happens on the court.

"I never thought it would get this big," said Kidd, one of the nation's premier high school basketball players. The 6-foot-4 Kidd averages 25.3 points, eight assists and 6.5 rebounds per game.

He was named a McDonald's 1992 All-American and co-player of the year on the Parade Magazine High School All-America team.

"I thought, maybe in the NBA ... but not in high school," he said of his celebrity status, something he tries hard not to dwell on.

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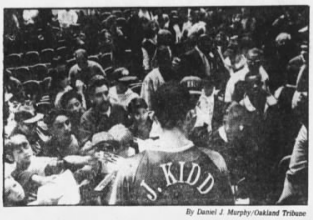

By Daniel J. Murphy/Oakland Tribune

Jason Kidd signs autographs for his fans.

Grandmas called the forgotten caregivers

By Judy Ronningen
Tribune staff writer

Long after they thought the days of dirty diapers and chicken pox were over, some grandmothers have to start anew raising grandkids because their adult children are addicted to crack cocaine.

A major study based in Oakland and released yesterday found that these grandparents often are forced to give up their jobs, cash in their retirement nest eggs and ignore their own health problems when the grandchildren arrive.

The 71 grandmothers in the study put their own travel plans and retirement goals on hold. Even simple things, such as a trip to the beauty parlor, get deferred, said Meredith Minkler of the University of California at Berkeley, co-author of the study.

"I got a taste of freedom a year ago," one grandmother told researchers. "I was just finished raising my children. I'd go around everywhere, do what I wanted to do."

Then she got custody of three children under age 5. "Now, when I go out, they come too," she said.

Minkler and co-author Kathleen Roe of San Jose State University found grandparents from a variety of neighborhoods and income levels with the help of a community advisory group. They ranged in age from 41 to 79; some cared for great-grandchildren.

"They were amazingly strong, amazingly committed to do whatever they had to do to give those children a better life," said Minkler, a professor of public health.

But the grandparents are treated unfairly by a government that provides less help to them than it would if strangers were raising the children, Minkler and Roe concluded.

Most of the grandparents received Aid to Families with Dependent Children benefits of $326 or $345 a month for one child, with a decreasing amount

See STUDY, Page A-9

Run for Cover

By Daniel J. Murphy/Oakland Tribune

Bob Peterson of Lafayette runs through Oakland's City Center to escape the rain. Brief but impressive downpours alternated with sunny periods throughout the day yesterday. Although the Eastbay had dried out by last night, don't put the rain gear away just yet. Showers are likely again today and into tomorrow morning. The extended forecast calls for a chance of rain again by Friday.

Brown rakes Clintons

By John King
The Associated Press

CHICAGO — Front-runner Bill Clinton heatedly defended himself and his wife, Hillary, against charges of unethical conduct last night as Democratic presidential rivals clashed in scathingly personal terms two days before critical Midwestern primaries.

"You ought to be ashamed for jumping on my wife," Clinton said to Jerry Brown after the former California governor leveled charges of improper behavior. "You're not worth being on the same platform with my wife."

Paul Tsongas was not involved in that exchange, but he jumped in to accuse Clinton of distributing false and misleading campaign literature in Illinois, which holds one of two primaries this week, as well as last week in Florida.

It was easily the most acid few minutes of the many debates staged for Democratic presidential contenders beginning late last year, and came as the polls said Clinton was poised for victories in Illinois and Michigan that could put him out of his rivals' reach in the race for the nomination.

And it continued after the debate ended.

"There's a scandal a week here," Brown said of Clinton, while Tsongas said Clinton's involve-

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6.0 aftershock rattles Turkey

By Terry Leonard
The Associated Press

ERZINCAN, Turkey — Another strong earthquake struck eastern Turkey yesterday, just two days after one that killed as many as 800 people and left 180,000 homeless.

Panicked residents ran into the streets and power was knocked out.

The new shock came as tents and food aid poured into this city, a quarter of which was reduced to rubble by Friday's earthquake.

A government official said many of the collapsed buildings were poorly constructed or higher than the city's three-story limit.

There were no immediate reports of casualties from yesterday's aftershock, which was centered in Tunceli province and felt from the Soviet

See QUAKE, Page A-9

By Michael Macor/Oakland Tribune

TREASURE TROVE

For almost 50 years, Ed Kovell has bought and sold second-hand equipment in Oakland without a hassle. But now, city inspectors want Kovell to spruce up his AAA Equipment yard near the Coliseum. Money Monday, C-1.

USDA doesn't always buy from U.S. farmers

Foreign products used in feeding programs

By Jennifer Dixon
The Associated Press

WASHINGTON — The Agriculture Department has a congressional mandate to buy American. But it has bought foreign foods to stock school cafeterias, soup kitchens, Indian reservations and the pantries of hunger relief agencies.

The department's own investigators say it does a poor job of making sure that the billions of taxpayer dollars spent every year on food goes back into the pockets of American farmers and food processors.

As a result, imported foods have slipped into the pipeline, according to an audit by USDA's Office of Inspector General obtained recently by The Associated Press under the Freedom of Information Act.

Foreign meat, including Canadian beef, appears to be one of the culprits, the audit said. USDA, however, has little way to assess the scope of the problem because of the shortcomings in its enforcement and regulations of contractors and their suppliers.

Congress and the department's own regulations say USDA is supposed to buy American foods and farm products when it shops for anti-hunger programs at home and abroad. It's also supposed to make sure that subsidized foreign customers are purchasing American goods.

Sen. Kent Conrad, D-N.D., said

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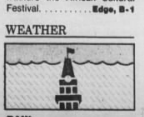
INSIDE

BROTHERS UNITED?
Fraternal disputes threaten to fracture the African Cultural Festival. ..... **Edgs, B-1**

WEATHER



RAIN
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